

Transcript 1

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Interviewer:

"Hi, I'm conducting a short academic survey on social media and misinformation. With your permission, may I record your responses?"

Participant:

"Yeah, that's fine. You can record. My name is Sahith, I'm 20 years old."

Interviewer: Can you tell me which social media platforms you use most often?

Participant: I mostly use Instagram and YouTube. Instagram especially for reels, and YouTube for longer videos.

Interviewer: How frequently do you rely on social media for news or important information?

Participant: Almost every day. I don't search for news, but it just appears on my feed.

Interviewer: Have you ever seen information online that you later realized was false? What was it about?

Participant: Yes, recently there was a post about a university exam rule change, which turned out to be fake.

Interviewer: What made you believe or trust that information initially?

Participant: It looked official and was shared by many student pages, so I assumed it was real.

Interviewer: How did you eventually find out it was incorrect?

Participant: The college released an official notice saying it wasn't true.

Interviewer: Did that misinformation affect your opinion or any decision you made?

Participant: Yes, I was stressed and even started preparing differently for a short time.

Interviewer: Have you ever shared something that later turned out to be false? What happened?

Participant: Yes, I shared that same post with friends and later had to correct myself.

Interviewer: Do you feel social media shows you certain types of content more often? Why?

Participant: Yes, mostly entertainment and student-related content, probably because I engage with it more.

Interviewer: Do you think posts with more likes, shares, or comments are more likely to appear in

your feed?

Participant: Definitely, viral posts show up more.

Interviewer: What do you think is the biggest problem caused by misinformation online?

Participant: It spreads quickly and creates confusion, especially among students.

Interviewer:

"I'm going to tell you a piece of information. Please tell me whether you think it is real or fake, and why.

A viral post claims that drinking hot water every 15 minutes can completely prevent COVID-19 infection."

Participant:

"I think that's fake. It sounds like a common health myth. There's no proper scientific proof, and if it were true, it would be officially recommended."

Closing Statement (Interviewer):

"Thank you for your responses. This information will only be used for academic purposes and will not be shared anywhere on the internet.

TRANSCRIPT 2

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Interviewer:

"Hello, I'm conducting an academic survey on social media usage and misinformation. With your consent, may I record this conversation?"

Participant:

"Yes, I consent. My name is Ayush, I am 19 years old."

Interviewer: Which social media platforms do you use most often?

Participant: LinkedIn, Twitter, and sometimes YouTube.

Interviewer: How often do you rely on social media for news?

Participant: Several times a day, especially Twitter for quick updates.

Interviewer: Have you encountered false information online?

Participant: Yes, especially during elections—misleading statistics and edited videos.

Interviewer: Why did you trust it initially?

Participant: It was widely shared and presented professionally.

Interviewer: How did you find out it was incorrect?

Participant: I cross-checked with reliable news sources.

Interviewer: Did it affect your opinion or decisions?

Participant: Temporarily, yes, until I verified the facts.

Interviewer: Have you ever shared misinformation?

Participant: Once, I shared an article without verifying and later corrected it.

Interviewer: Do you see repeated types of content? Why?

Participant: Yes, mainly professional and political content due to algorithmic targeting.

Interviewer: Do engagement metrics affect visibility?

Participant: Absolutely, higher engagement increases reach.

Interviewer: Biggest problem caused by misinformation?

Participant: It can distort public perception and influence decision-making.

Interviewer:

"I'll read a statement. Please tell me if you think it's real or fake, and why.

A viral post claims that drinking hot water every 15 minutes can completely prevent COVID-19 infection."

Participant:

"This is misinformation. The claim is absolute and lacks scientific basis. Prevention of viral infections cannot rely on such a simple method."

Closing Statement (Interviewer):

"Thank you. This information will be used strictly for academic purposes and will not be shared publicly."

TRANSCRIPT 3

Interviewer:

"Hi, I'm conducting a short academic survey. With your permission, may I record your responses?"

Participant:

"Yeah, sure. That's fine. My name is Ayush, and I'm 21 years old."

Interviewer: Which social media platforms do you use most?

Participant: Mostly Instagram and YouTube. I spend more time on Instagram, especially reels, and YouTube for longer videos.

Interviewer: How often do you get news from social media?

Participant: Almost every day. I don't really search for news, but it just comes up on my feed.

Interviewer: Have you seen false information online?

Participant: Yeah, quite a few times. Mostly things like fake news about celebrities or some random updates about exams or trends.

Interviewer: Why did you believe it initially?

Participant: Mainly because it looked real and a lot of people had liked or shared it. So I didn't really question it at first.

Interviewer: How did you find out it was incorrect?

Participant: Later I checked online or saw people commenting that it wasn't true, and then I realized it was fake.

Interviewer: Did it affect your decisions?

Participant: Not in a big way, but yeah, sometimes it confused me or made me believe something for a while.

Interviewer: Have you shared false information?

Participant: Yeah, once or twice I shared posts or reels without checking. Later I found out they weren't accurate.

Interviewer: Do you see repeated content?

Participant: Yes, a lot. Especially similar reels or topics that I usually watch or like.

Interviewer: Do likes/shares affect visibility?

Participant: Definitely. Posts with more likes and shares show up more on my feed.

Interviewer: Biggest problem caused by misinformation?

Participant: It spreads really fast and people just believe it without checking, which creates confusion.

Interviewer:

"I'll tell you a message. Please say if it is real or fake, and why.

Drinking hot water every 15 minutes can completely prevent COVID-19."

Participant:

"I think it's fake. It sounds like one of those common myths that keep circulating online. If it was true, it would be officially confirmed by doctors or health organizations."

Closing Statement (Interviewer):

"Thank you for your time. This information will only be used for academic purposes and will not be shared anywhere on the internet.